

Uses



This thermometer contains mercury, which expands as it gets warmer and contracts as it cools.

Mercury thermometer



Pills containing mercury were commonly used to treat constipation and toothache.



Mercury pills

This bulb glows when the mercury vapour inside it is electrified.

CFL bulb

Mercury has been in use for more than **4,000 years.**

This bright red paint is made with powdered cinnabar.



Red paint

This large, low-cost mirror made of a pool of pure mercury is used in an astronomical telescope.

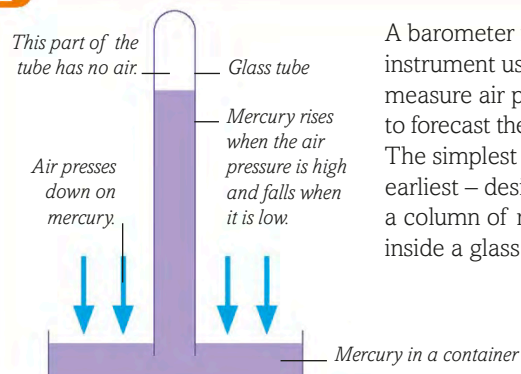
The needle moves with the rise and fall of mercury.



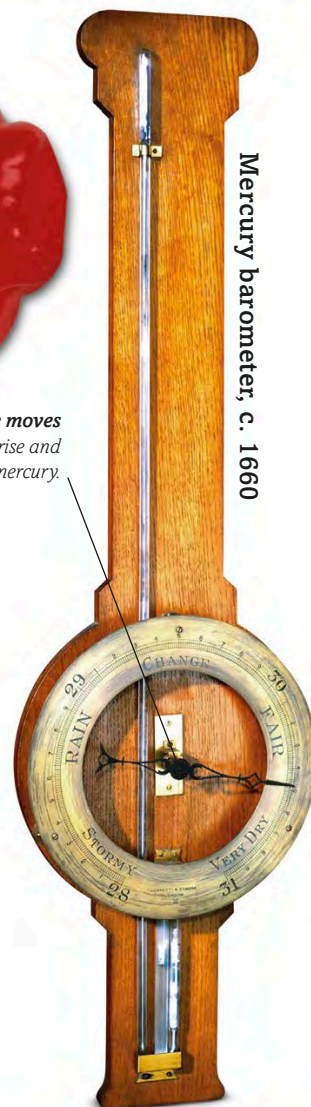
Liquid mirror inside telescope



HOW DOES A BAROMETER WORK?



A barometer is an instrument used to measure air pressure to forecast the weather. The simplest – and earliest – designs used a column of mercury inside a glass tube.



Mercury barometer, c. 1660

it can damage organs and nerves if inhaled or swallowed. As a result, the use of this metal is carefully monitored today. Mercury is used in some batteries, some **thermometers**, and in low-energy, **compact fluorescent light (CFL) bulbs**. Its compounds are used to prepare

strong, **red paints**. Until the early 18th century, mercury was used in **pills** for treating some common ailments. It gradually fell out of use when it was found to be toxic. The first accurate **barometers** also contained this liquid, but such devices are rarely seen today.